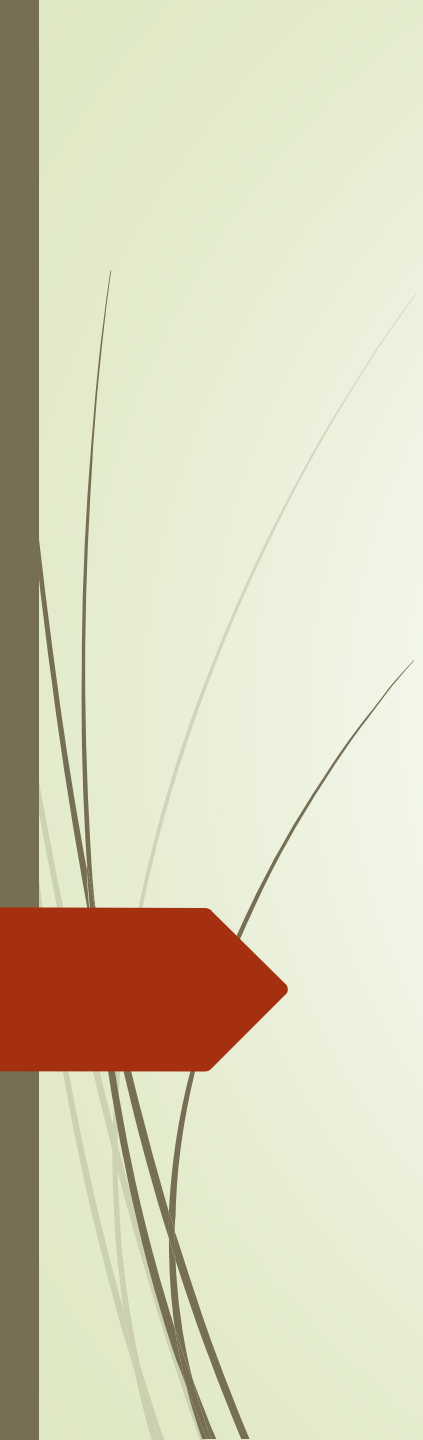




Communication in Virtual Teams: Challenges, Differences, and Strategies

Presented by: Wade Eckert

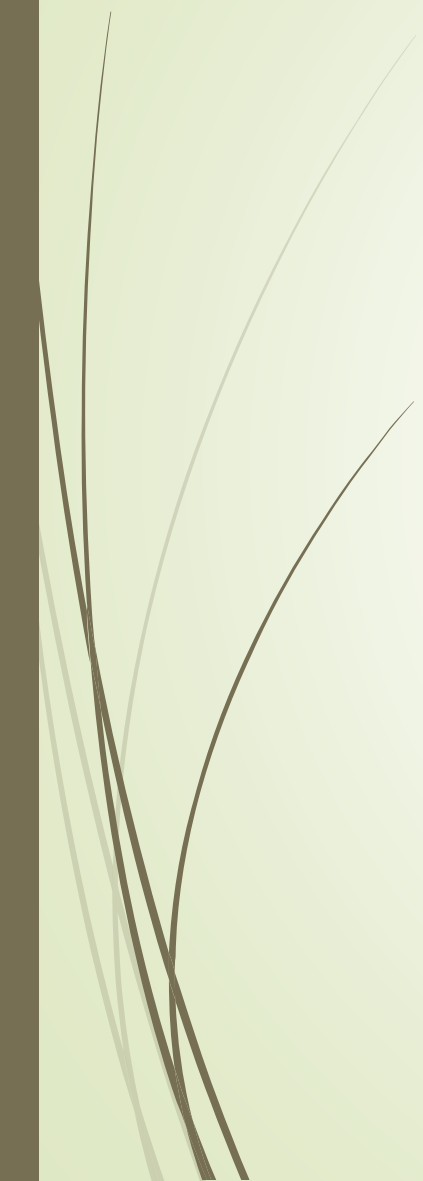
CSD 200: Foundations of Software Development

Instructor: Professor Chandra Bobba

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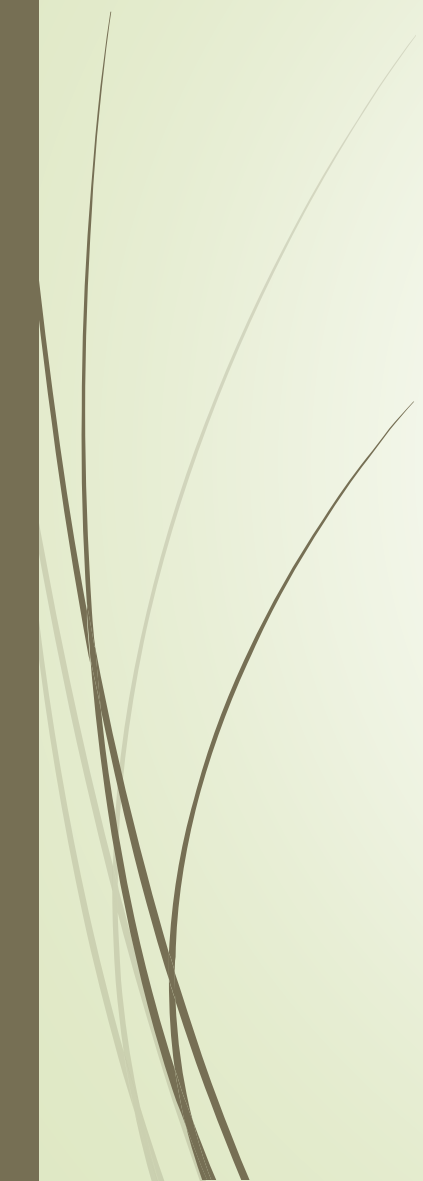
Introduction



- Virtual teams are now a regular part of the modern workplace.
- Good communication is key to an effective business or organization, but it can be tricky when done remotely.
- This presentation explores virtual communication challenges and offers practical ways to improve connection, trust, and collaboration.



Common Communication Challenges in Virtual Teams

- Different Time Zones: Hard to find an overlap for real-time meetings.
 - Missing Body Language: Messages can be misread.
 - Tech Troubles: Interruptions from the internet or unfamiliar tools and IT problems.
 - Less Social Interaction: Harder to build relationships with fellow employees.
 - Misunderstandings: Tone and intent can get lost, especially in text-based formats (Hoch & Kozlowski, 2014).
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Virtual vs. Face-to-Face Communication

➤ **Virtual Teams:**

- Reliant on digital tools (email, chat, video).
- Limited access to spontaneous feedback.
- Greater chance of misunderstanding others without visual cues.

➤ **Face-to-Face Teams:**

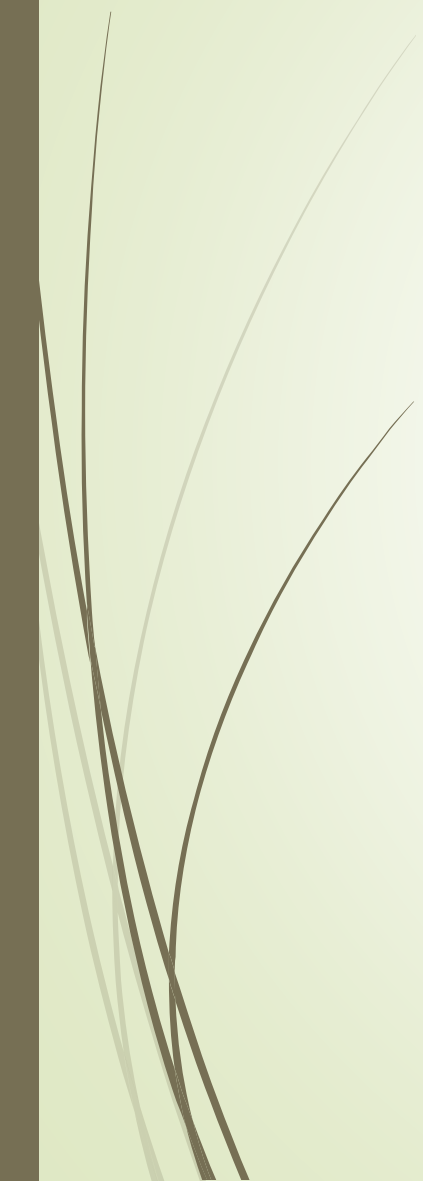
- Rich communication through tone, body language, and immediate interaction.
- Easier to establish rapport with employees and provide clarity.

➤ **Similarities:**

- Both require active listening, clarity, and follow-up for effective two-way communication.

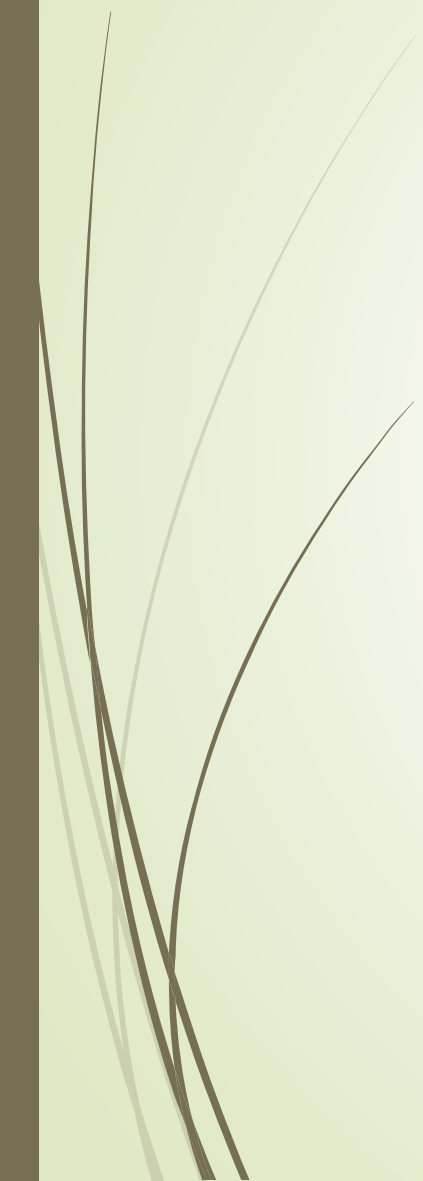


How to Build Trust and Two-Way Communication

- Set Clear Expectations: Everyone should know how and when to communicate.
 - Turn on the Camera: Boosts engagement for all members of a team.
 - Be Open and Encouraging: Create space for input and be open to constructive criticism.
 - Follow Up and Follow Through: Show you are reliable and trustworthy.
 - Celebrate Wins: Always take the time to celebrate the advancements and improvements of all team members (Edmondson, 2019).
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How to Improve Body Language Virtually

- Optimize Video Presence: Maintain eye-level camera placement and proper lighting to simulate in-person cues.
 - Utilize Expressive Facial Cues: Smile, nod, and use natural expressions to convey attentiveness and empathy.
 - Engage in Purposeful Gesturing: Use hand and body movements to emphasize points and mirror natural conversation.
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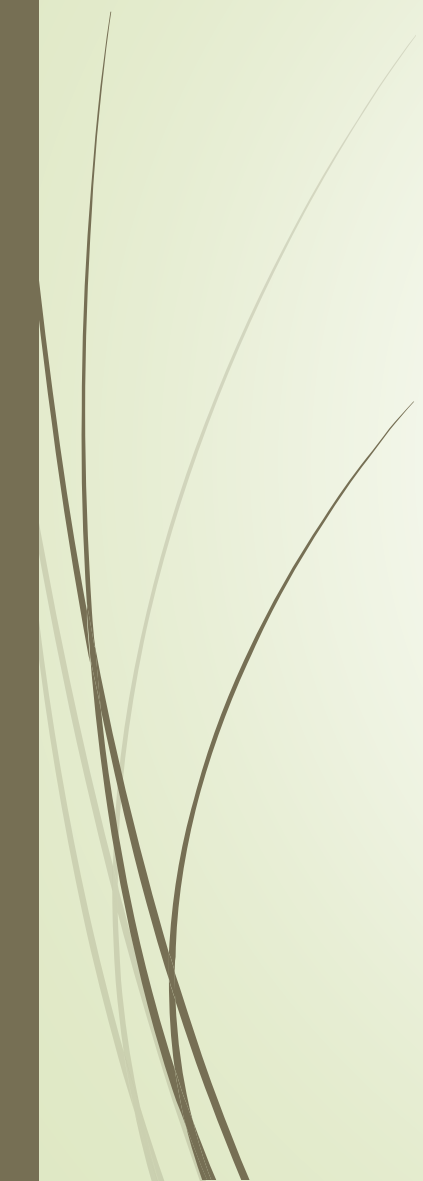


Helpful Tools and Practices

- Communication Platforms: Zoom, Teams, Slack.
- Task Management: Asana, Trello, Monday.
- File Sharing: Google Drive, SharePoint, GitHub.
- Team Culture: Use virtual chats and check-ins to build connections between team members (Dulebohn & Hoch, 2017).



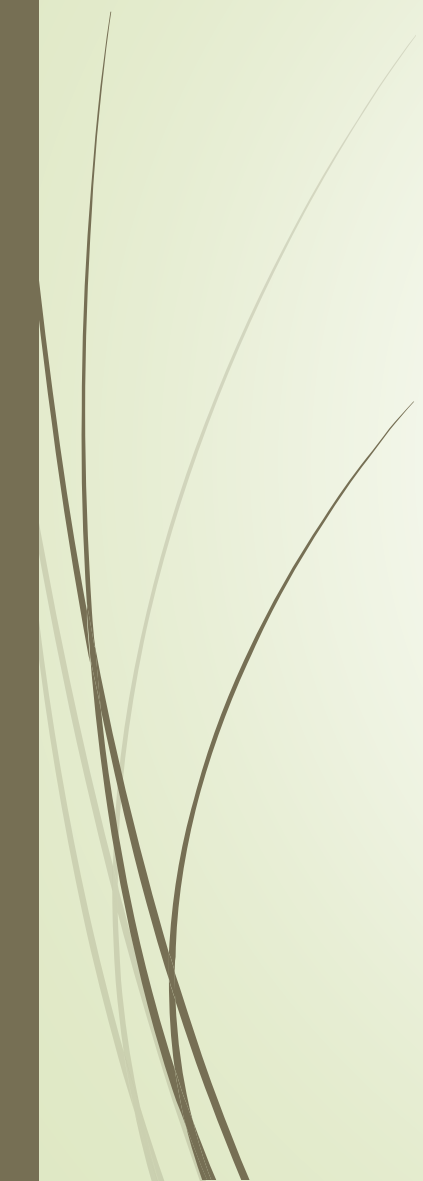
Final Thoughts



- Communicating well in a virtual team takes effort, but it's worth it if done correctly. Extra care must be taken to ensure that virtual communication is being done correctly and effectively. Ask for constant feedback from team members.
- With the right tools, habits, and mindset, remote teams can succeed, but everyone must make a concerted effort to improve.
- Communication is everyone's responsibility, and the more people who embrace this mindset, the better the overall effectiveness of a business will be.



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